

A player finished three runs without knowing the goal

100 / 100

PURGE CELL ×1

0 CARGO

SECTOR 1/3

BASALT GALLERIES

DESCEND THE SHAFT



2026-08-16

The sentence that opened the ticket

Somebody played blind: three runs, no guide, getting further each time. Then he wrote: "I didn't exactly know what the exact goal was." The goal is written down, in the Induction, article two, in the company's own voice. He read it. It did not land. That is a design problem, and the fix is never a longer paragraph.

The document already knew



DISPATCH

INDUCTION

GENERATIONAL MATRIX

LOG

OPTIONS

OPERATOR COPY

OPERATOR INDUCTION

AD-IND-0001 · required reading

– ore still in the chassis is ore lost. Descending is optional; coming back is what pays.

§3 · ENVIRONMENT

THE VEIN REACTS

None of it is scenery. Brittle rock gives way to gunfire, fire walks across anything dry, current crosses any pool and acid eats what it touches – your chassis included. Aurix holds no documentation on what happens when two of those meet. Caution is advised. It is noted that caution rarely recovers Cores.

§4 · ARMAMENT

THE BARREL HAS A LIMIT

The weapon heats with every shot and locks when it saturates. The thin bar under your health is heat, and the mark on it is where the audible warning starts. A held trigger is the most common cause of unit loss in this programme.

§5 · WELL

THE VEIN LISTENS

Wells offer abilities, and the offer is not a lottery: it answers what you have been doing. What you burned, electrified or detonated comes back as equipment. An equipped ability has a cooldown – the command bar along the bottom says when it returns.

§6 · ARCHIVE

READ THE MATRIX

Every recovered unit feeds the GENERATIONAL MATRIX. That is where the Aurix Files live – what the company knows about each Asset you met down there, released as you meet it – alongside the hardware protocols that authorise the next generation to descend further, take more and aim better. What you leave unread keeps happening to you.

COMMAND SCHEME · DESK TERMINAL

WASD

MOVE

LMB

FIRE

SPACE

DODGE

Q

ABILITY

F

PURGE

E

INTERACT

ESC

MENU

On a touch device the scheme differs: left stick moves, right stick aims and fires, and the buttons above it repeat this list.

AUTHORISE DESCENT

TRAINING OPERATION

This document stays in dispatch, under INDUCTION.

A comment at the top of induction.ts has been confessing this for weeks: it is not a guided tutorial, it makes the first descent legible rather than solving it. It was right about itself. Reading about a dodge has never taught anybody to dodge.

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The Training Operation

Two to three minutes, five exercises: move, fire, dash, take the Core, get out alive. Permanent on the terminal and offered on the first read of the briefing, with the big stamp still sending you to the real Vein. Never mandatory, in either place.

Zero lines in the simulation



The trick is a run config that already existed: one sector, Core in it. Sector one never has a boss, so the pedestal is live from the first frame, and extracting with the Core there produces the SAME outcome a real expedition does. The real HUD teaches it alone: FIND THE CORE flips to EXTRACT AT THE ENTRANCE.

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The course is carved

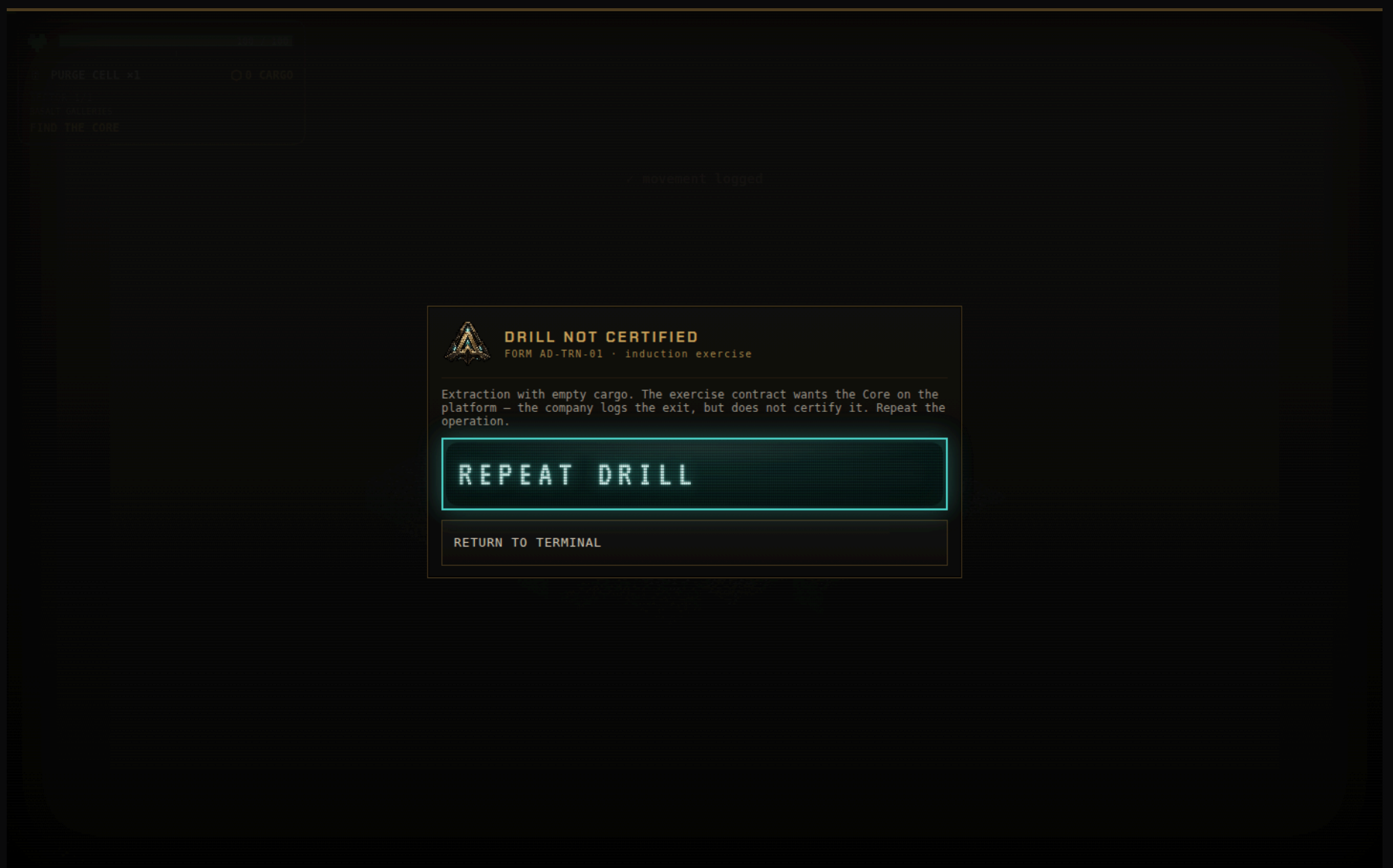
A normal sector is generated from a fixed seed, then cut into before the first tick: platform, gallery, firing chamber, pillar corridor, pedestal. Everything outside becomes plain rock, because sealed rock keeps its crystal, and crystal emits light in a place the drill just declared does not exist.

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The soft lock that almost shipped

The course has no doors. You can ignore the dash prompt and lift the Core early. If that step listened only for the event, it would be discarded and the drill would wait forever for a second Core that does not exist. Irreversible facts are checked as facts, repeatable actions as events.

Favourite bug of the month



Extracting empty handed certified the drill: four tiles out, four back, press E, and the game congratulated you for learning nothing. Now an empty extraction gets its own outcome and the button becomes REPEAT DRILL.

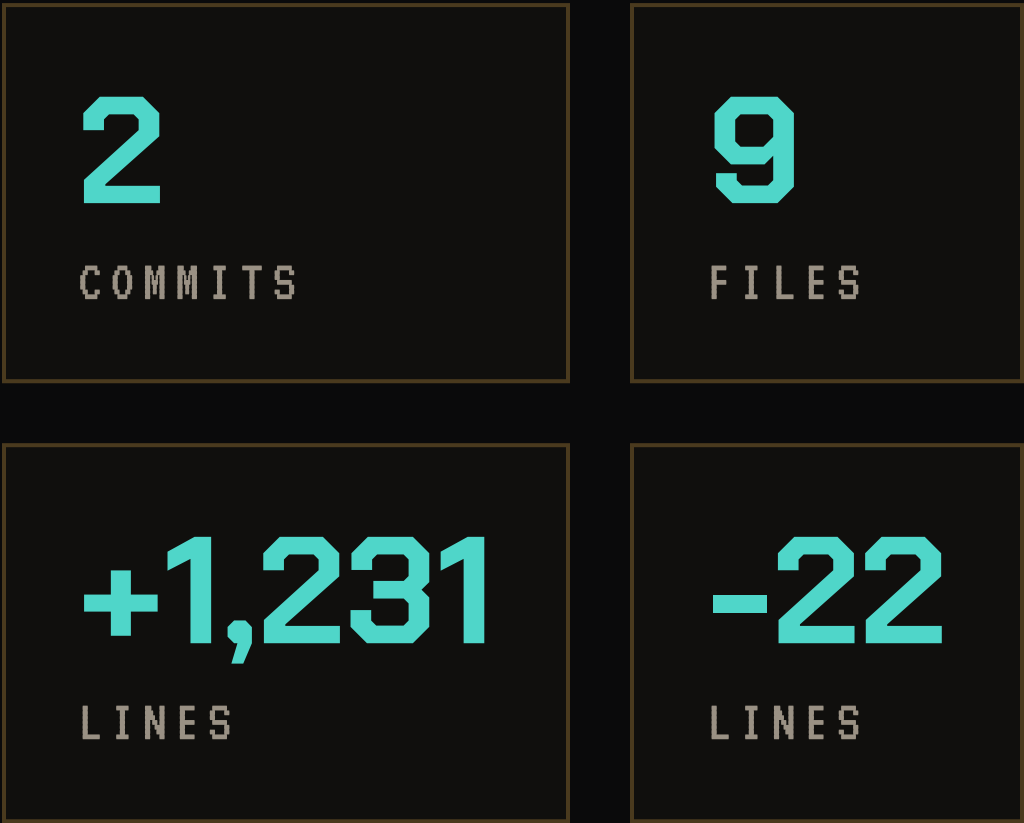
2026-08-16

What it refuses to do

It never blocks you, never unlocks anything, and pays exactly nothing, and the form says so out loud. When it does teach, it teaches with the real thing: same Core, same key, same HUD, same extraction that will later decide whether an hour of cargo banks or evaporates.

WHAT LANDED

PR #145



- 95a49c9 Add the Training Operation: a playable first-descent drill
- c68c7fe Training: require the Core to certify, and settle run state at the form